# ELEPHANT FOOT

# Client Account Setup & Website Handoff Guide

Follow this guide before and during your website project. It is designed so you own your website, code, domain, hosting, analytics, and third-party accounts.

Client/business: _____
Website domain: _____
Elephant Foot project contact: _____

## Before you begin

This guide helps you create accounts you own and give Elephant Foot temporary project access. You should use an email address you control, your own payment method, and your own passwords. Do not send passwords by text or email.

You will usually need: a domain registrar account, GitHub, Vercel, a Google account for Analytics, an email inbox for contact-form leads, and accounts for any booking or payment tools you want to use.

## 1. Create a GitHub account

1. Go to github.com and create an account using an email you control.
2. Verify your email address and enable two-factor authentication if available.
3. Send Elephant Foot your GitHub username—not your password.
4. Elephant Foot will tell you whether to create an empty repository or accept an invitation to a project repository.
5. When asked, invite Elephant Foot as a collaborator. Use the email or GitHub username supplied by Elephant Foot.

**Your result:** You can see and control the complete source code and project history.

## 2. Create a Vercel account

1. Go to vercel.com and sign up using your own email or GitHub account.
2. Verify your account and review the plan and billing details before accepting them.
3. Create a team only if Elephant Foot asks you to. Otherwise, your personal account may be enough for a simple site.
4. Invite Elephant Foot to the project or team after Elephant Foot gives you the correct email address.
5. Do not share your Vercel password or payment card details.

**Your result:** You own the website deployment, hosting settings, environment variables, domains connected in Vercel, and any hosting charges.

## 3. Buy or access your domain

If you do not own a domain:
1. Choose a registrar and buy the domain using your own email and payment method.
2. Turn on renewal reminders and confirm your contact email is correct.
3. Keep the registrar login and renewal information safe.

If you already own a domain:

1. Confirm you can sign in to the registrar.
2. Tell Elephant Foot the domain name.
3. Elephant Foot will send the DNS records or connection instructions needed to point the domain to your site.

Do not transfer domain ownership to Elephant Foot. Do not send your registrar password. If the registrar offers collaborator access, use that only when needed and remove it after launch.

**Your result:** You own the domain and control renewals.

## 4. Set up Google Analytics

1. Use a Google account you control, or create one for the business.
2. Go to analytics.google.com and create a Google Analytics property for your business/site.
3. Create a web data stream using your final website address when available.
4. In Analytics, go to Admin, then Account or Property Access Management.
5. Add Elephant Foot using the Google email address provided by Elephant Foot. Give only the access needed for setup; Elephant Foot can tell you the recommended role.
6. After launch, confirm that a test visit appears in Analytics.

**Your result:** You own your website analytics and can remove Elephant Foot access at any time.

## 5. Choose your contact-form setup

Choose where website inquiries should go:
• Your normal business email inbox, or
• A client-owned form service account, if your website needs one.

If Elephant Foot asks you to create a form-service account, create it with your own business email and payment method. Invite Elephant Foot as a project user if the provider supports it, or follow Elephant Foot instructions for sharing only project-specific configuration—not your password.

Before launch, tell Elephant Foot the inbox that should receive contact-form messages. After launch, submit a test message and confirm you received it.

## 6. Booking, payments and other tools

If you use Calendly, Square, Stripe, Shopify, a CRM, newsletter tool, or another service:
1. Create or use an account owned by you or your business.
2. Complete its verification, billing, and legal settings yourself.
3. Send Elephant Foot the public booking, storefront, or profile link—or invite Elephant Foot with limited project access if necessary.
4. Never provide full-account passwords or payment-card information.

Elephant Foot can add links, buttons, embeds, or agreed integrations. Elephant Foot does not own your customer payments, business accounts, or customer data.

## 7. Give Elephant Foot access safely

Use invitations and limited permissions whenever possible. Elephant Foot may need access to GitHub, Vercel, Analytics, a form provider, or DNS settings to build and launch the site.

Before inviting Elephant Foot, verify the email or username directly with Elephant Foot. Do not send passwords through a form, email, or text. Remove access that is no longer needed after launch unless you purchase ongoing maintenance.

## 8. Launch review

Before launch, review the preview link and check:
• Business name, services, prices, hours, location, phone and email.
• Photos, logo, testimonials, and any claims made on the site.
• Contact-form destination email.
• Booking/payment links, if used.
• Your preferred domain spelling and final pages.

Send feedback in one organized list. Give written approval only when the site matches the agreed scope.

## 9. Handoff checklist

After payment and launch, Elephant Foot will provide your live website link, source-code repository link, and basic editing/setup information. Confirm all of the following:
■ You can sign in to your domain registrar.
■ You can sign in to GitHub and see the full repository.
■ You can sign in to Vercel and see the production project.
■ You can sign in to Google Analytics, if included.
■ Your contact form sends inquiries to your inbox.
■ You control your booking, payment, and other third-party accounts.
■ You know which services renew and who pays for them.
■ You received a handoff email or document listing the accounts and support terms.
■ Elephant Foot access has been removed, unless a maintenance agreement says otherwise.

## Need help?

If you get stuck, send Elephant Foot a screenshot of the page you are on, without showing passwords, payment details, recovery codes, or other sensitive information. We can guide you through the next step.